

DRISHTI GOEL

Ph.D. Candidate UIUC | Prev. Research Fellow, Microsoft Research

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🌐 <https://drishti-illini.github.io>

🎓 Google Scholar

🌐 LinkedIn

EDUCATION

University of Illinois, Urbana-Champaign

2025 – Present

Ph.D. (Direct Entry) in Computer Science, Advisor: **Prof. Koustuv Saha**

→ Research support: *Jump ARCHES*; previously *Qualcomm Innovation Fellowship*

Dayalbagh Educational Institute, Agra

2019 – 2023

B.Tech in Electrical Engineering (Specialization in Computer Science)

CGPA: 9.573/10.00

→ University Founder's Medal (1 out of ≈ 5000) & Director's Medals Recipient (1 out of ≈ 500)

EXPERIENCE

1. Microsoft Research – Future Experiences (FX)

May, 2026 - Aug, 2026

Research Intern | Advisors: Dr. Martez Mott, Dr. Denae Ford Robinson

Redmond, USA

Collaborators: Dr. Ed Cutrell, Dr. John Tang, Ann Paradiso

2. Microsoft-365 Research

August, 2023 - August, 2025

Research Fellow | Advisors: Dr. Supriyo Ghosh, Chetan Bansal

Bangalore, India

Collaborators: Dr. Thomas Zimmermann, Dr. Xuchao Zhang, Dr. Anjaly Parayil, Dr. Akshay Nambi

→ Worked on AI for IT and Cloud Systems (AIOPs), LLMs & SLMs for service reliability in large-scale cloud systems and developer productivity & satisfaction

→ In addition to the research impact, the work has also been adopted by over 130 teams across Microsoft

3. Grahn Lab, University of Western Ontario

June - August, 2022

MITACS GRI Research Intern | Advisors: Prof. Jessica Grahn, Dr. Swathi Swaminathan

London, Canada

→ Using Pupillometry to detect emotions induced by music in Alzheimer's Patients

→ Skills Acquired: Conducting systematic reviews, developing search strategies and working on various databases and database managers, Pupillometry, and conducting testing sessions.

4. NeenOpal Inc.

Jan - May, 2022

Data Science Intern | Advisor: Raghav Kedia

Bangalore, India

→ Business intelligence and ML-driven decision-making using Power BI, Tableau, and Google Analytics

→ Articles: Power BI Screenshot Automation, Visualizing the World Using Power BI

5. Geniusup India Pvt. Ltd.

June - August, 2021

Topic Modeling using Latent Dirichlet Allocation (LDA)

Agra, India (Online)

→ Skills Acquired: Web Scraping, Data Cleansing, and Visualization (using Python), Machine Learning (unsupervised), Latent Dirichlet Allocation (LDA) Algorithm, High-level document drafting

PUBLICATIONS

$S = \text{UNDER SUBMISSION}$, $C = \text{CONFERENCE}$ (* = EQUAL CONTRIBUTION)

[S.4] CareMirror: Bringing Caregiver Wellbeing into the Dementia Care Ecosystem

JiaYue Melissa Shi, Ethan Nguyen, [Drishti Goel](#), Upasana Natarajan, Shashwat Srivatsa, Daniel S. Brown, Violeta J. Rodriguez, Dong Whi Yoo, Indira Uniyal, Ravi Karkar, Koustuv Saha

[C.7] Rubric-Driven Risk Mitigation in Caregiver-AI Interactions Optimization

[Drishti Goel](#), Jeongah Lee, Qiuyue Zhong, Violeta J. Rodriguez, Daniel S. Brown, Ravi Karkar, Dong Whi Yoo, Koustuv Saha

ACM Association for Computational Linguistics

[ACL'26]

[S.3] A Taxonomy of Mental Health and Technology Needs for Alzheimer's and Dementia Caregivers

Keran Wang, [Drishti Goel](#), Jiayue Melissa Shi, Violeta J. Rodriguez, Daniel S. Brown, Dong Whi Yoo, Ravi Karkar, Koustuv Saha

[C.6] When AI Says "I have been in similar situations": Synthetic Lived Experience in Peer-Like Caregiver Support

[Drishti Goel](#), Agam Goyal, Veda Duddu, Olivia Pal, Violeta J. Rodriguez, Daniel S. Brown, Ravi Karkar, Dong Whi Yoo, Koustuv Saha

ACM Conference on Human-AI Complementarity and Alignment

[HCOMP'26]

[S.2] Inform, Coach, Relate, Listen: Auditing LLM Caregiving Support Roles

[Drishti Goel](#), Agam Goyal, Veda Duddu, Olivia Pal, Jeongah Lee, Qiuyue Joy Zhong, Violeta J. Rodriguez, Daniel S. Brown, Dong Whi Yoo, Ravi Karkar, Koustuv Saha

- [S.1] **FixItFlow: Automated Troubleshooting Guide Generation from Cloud Incidents** 
Srihari Unnikrishnan, Jaskaran Singh Walia, Drishti Goel, Supriyo Ghosh
- [C.5] **Do We Know What They Know We Know? Calibrating Student Trust in AI and Human Responses Through Mutual Theory of Mind** 
Olivia Pal, Veda Duddu, Agam Goyal, Drishti Goel, Koustuv Saha
ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems [CHI'26]
- [C.4] **Efficient Automated Root Cause Analysis with Prompt Optimization** 
Drishti Goel, Raghav Magazine, Supriyo Ghosh, Akshay Nambi, Prathamesh Deshpande, Xuchao Zhang, Chetan Bansal, Saravan Rajmohan
IEEE/ACM International Conference on Automated Software Engineering [ASE'26]
- [C.3] **Time Warp: The Gap Between Developers' Ideal vs Actual Workweeks in an AI Driven Era** 
Sukrit Kumar*, Drishti Goel*, Thomas Zimmermann, Brian Houck, B. Ashok, Chetan Bansal
 **Distinguished Paper Award** *International Conference On Software Engineering* [ICSE-SEIP'25]
- [C.2] **Prototype-Reservation for Explainable Classification under Imbalanced & Scarce-Data Settings** 
Vaibhav Ganatra, Drishti Goel
Machine Learning in Healthcare (University of Toronto) [MLHC'24]
- [C.1] **X-lifecycle Learning for Cloud Incident Management using LLMs** 
Drishti Goel, Fiza Husain, Aditya Singh, Supriyo Ghosh, Anjaly Parayil, Chetan Bansal, Xuchao Zhang, Saravan Rajmohan
ACM International Conference on the Foundations of Software Engineering [FSE'24]

AWARDS & ACHIEVEMENTS

1. Funded by the **Qualcomm Innovation Fellowship** at UIUC 2025
2. Recieved the **Distinguished Paper Award** at the International Conference On Software Engineering 2025
3. **University Founder's Medal** Recipient (1 out of ≈ 5000 graduates) 2024
→ Awarded annually to a student for academic excellence, social service, and an all-rounder personality
4. **Director's Medal**– Two times recipient (1 out of ≈ 500 graduates) 2024
→ Awarded for scoring the highest Grade-Point Average across all engineering streams, and
→ For scoring the highest grades in Cultural Education across the University
5. **MITACS Globalink Research Scholarship** Recipient ($\approx$ CAD 8,000) | University of Western Ontario 2022
→ Eligible to receive the MITACS Globalink Graduate Fellowship ($\approx$ CAD 15,000)
6. Amongst the 15 students, selected for a student exchange program with the **Hong Kong University** 2020
out of $\approx 3,000$ university applicants
7. Received the runners-up position at the Zonal-level Debate Competition at the AIU Youth Festival 2019
→ Represented Region at the **National Level**

TALKS & PRESENTATIONS

1. Guest Speaker @Google Developer Student Club on “The Fundamentals & Applications of ML” 2022
2. University representative and speaker at the Engineer's Day conference alongside **Mr. Sam Pitroda** 2021
→ The internationally renowned telecoms innovator and policymaker.
3. Project– “Entrepreneurial Methodology to Increase the Income of Rural Areas in India” 2020
→ Qualified & presented at the **AICTE CVA National Level** to the Education Minister of India
4. Presented my project, “Preservation and Integration of the Heritage of India and Hong Kong” 2020
→ In collaboration with **The Hong Kong University**
5. Selected– “Frugal Innovation with Foldscope” workshop, by Dr. Manu Prakash from **Stanford University** 2019

LEADERSHIP POSITIONS

- **Reviewer**– Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS) 2026
- **Student Volunteering**– ACM AI Leadership Summit (SV Chair), ACL 2026
- **Author**– “Defy Your Gravity: Rise Above Challenges & Embrace Your Potential”  2025
- **Active Volunteer**– Fostering Cultural Diversity among Young Minds through Arts  2023-Present
- **‘MAA’**– A social initiative to help Indian village women achieve financial independence 2021
→ Work presented at the National Level of the **AICTE Chattra Vishwakarma Award Competition**
- University Chair, IEEE Women in Engineering 2020 – 2023
- **Member**: IEEE Computer Society, IEL, System Society Of India, University's Incubation Cell 2019 – 2023